

HackSoc Annual General Meeting

Minutes for 2020-05-14

Present: Aaron Osher (Chair), Alexander Dewfall, Archie Hilton, Aryan Kankaria, Bonnie Wu, Danielius Zurllys, Edward Smith, Hani Momeninia, Hannah Lester, Jacob Garby, James Frost, John Mercer, Keval Kapdee, Leanne Payne (Associate Member), Luka Corliss, Mia Mukherjee, Molly Shalliker, Myeongwoo Lee, Natasha Bayliss, Neve Marpole, Peter Taylor, Primoz Fabiani, Reece Harvey, Reece Roberts, Ryan Hardwick, Samuel King, Tara Dilley, Zac Garby

Also present: Ashleigh Haxie (Taking Minutes)

Announcements

1. Daniel Cordell appointed to chair the meeting

Reports

HackSoc Year in Review - Aaron Osher

1. Year-on-year Revenue is £25,000 with the society spending £18,000
margins accounted for £8,500 in revenue, and spent £4,000
HackNotts 2020 accounted for £12,500 in revenue, and spent £11,000
HHEU Unconference accounted for £2,500 in revenue and expenditure
2. HackNotts 2020 had over 150 hackers, 25 staff, and 20 sponsor reps. and judges.
The event has continued the trend of exceeding past years, and the revamp to the organisational structure for 2020, has put the event on target to do the same
3. Bruce Bernard II, the giant teddy-bear, has greatly improved our social media presence in the UK hacker scene
The bear has also attended four hackathons on two continents
4. We met our goal of running at least 2 events per week throughout the year
We initially found ourselves battling some welfare related issues, and streamlined our events process in December to resolve this
5. Member engagement has generally been up over the last year
We don't keep records, but we've also noticed generally a more diverse range of attendees at events over last year
6. Weekend workshops replacing series has worked incredibly well
Moving our multi-week series to weekend events has resulted in better attendance numbers, and more engaged attendees
7. We've continued to maintain our relationship with Tech Nottingham

8. Speaker events

We brought in 20 external speakers this year, a substantial increase over the 12 we had in 2019

Our multi-speaker events were huge successes

9. External Hackathons

In January we started going to Hackathons for the first time in years

We've smashed attendee numbers at events like CovHack, making up 20% of the event's attendees

We've also subsidised hired transport for the first time to account for the significant engagement

Old Business

1. Setting of 2020/21 membership fee

Not motioned during the meeting, will resolve at EGM

Constitution Amendments

1. An Update of the partner secretary role as proposed by Samuel King - [hacksocnotts/constitution#44](#)

Role will be more focused on general liaison with industry speakers and partners

Questions

AD: Is this to benefit the society or just tailor it to what you want to do?

SK: Feels it will benefit the society as a whole and it will provide new ways to reach out and get support from industry, as he has quite a log of partners.

Voting Result: Passed

For: 22

Against: 1

Abstain: 5

2. Byelaw compliance update proposed by Aaron Osher - [hacksocnotts/constitution#45](#)

Procedural amendment to update to match SU structures

President has been set to chair, and updated an erroneous reference to the societies officer to the activities officer.

Various typo corrections

Voting Result: Passed

For: 23

Against: 0

Abstain: 6

3. Replace social media and communications officer with separate social media and marketing secretaries proposed by Aaron Osher - [hacksocnotts/constitution#46](#)

Separate out Marketing will handle newsletters, mailing lists, website, SU and similar.
Social media will handle twitter, engagement, and similar.

Voting Result: Passed

For: 21

Against: 5

Abstain: 3

Hustings

Vice President

1. *Alexander Dewfall*

The role being originally defined around him and his work with HackNotts (HN)

Was originally required as Alexi joined as HN organiser

Experience and Skills from working with streamfleet which has given organisational skills

Works with tight timelines with event cadence Involved, proved he can do the role

2. *Raj Gohire*

Not present - no presentation for VP Role provided

Questions — None Asked

President

1. *Aaron Osher*

Originally looking to revamping events, making things regular to increase engagement

Struggled around an outgoing committee of 9 people, handover is yet to become a smooth process.

Questions — None Asked

Treasurer

1. *Raj Gohire*

Has experience enough to handle the responsibilities and duties.

Has 2 years of experience of the role, working with 2 clubs

Doubled previous profits of clubs

Quick learner, and able to handle unforeseen circumstances.

With Coronavirus, some companies may be more open to sponsorships to branch out in these trying times.

Funding may be difficult due to lack of support, so should prioritise essential events.

2. *Neve Marpole*

No specific experience as a treasurer, but feels she has the qualities and is willing to learn

HackSoc has a big budget, so she feels she can manage it responsibly

Wants to look into expenditure and sponsorships

Questions —

1. *AD*: How good are you at picking up new tools?

NM:

Can pick up tools pretty easily, as on compsci course.

Has experience from previous jobs, with various systems.

RG:

Not present

2. *JM*: Can you say no to Aaron?

NM: Can say no to Aaron

RG: Not present

General Secretary

1. *Reece Roberts*

Provide events of interest and engaging to society members

Wants to aid travel to Hackathons

Continue to aid organisation of talks, workshops and events.

Was a SU events officer this past year

Feels will be great for general administration.

Questions —

1. *AD*: Can you handle Reverse delegation of Aaron?

RR:

Feels he can say no, and would put things to democratic votes.

Development Secretary

1. *Danielius Zurllys*

Ready to perform required tasks around hacksoc, such as website admin.

Has some workshop Ideas - Python, Kotlin workshops

Game development using Python and OpenGL

2. *Lee Myeongwoo*

Increase easier and harder topic workshops

Create more programming workshops and cover more bases

3. *Peter Taylor*

Continue the maintenance of HackSoc.

Create more variety with workshops aimed at beginners and advanced

Create a series of workshops â€œYouâ€™ve written your code, what nowâ€

Services, Servers, the more sysadmin side of development.

Help students get their work into the open source community

Continue the programming Cafes

Showcase Society memberâ€™s work

4. Questions

SK: How will you make documentation fun?

PT: Emojis

Question was dismissed as it was specific to one candidate

MM: To all Devsec Applicants, what events this year have you liked, and what do you think could be improved about them?

DZ: Enjoyed Saturday events, with python and Kotlin, Cover it on multiple events, to separate out big topics

LM: Bad Code Hackathon, Expand it out to be bad AI hackathon?

PT: Events all in a room together, working on our own stuff together. Would be nice to have more.

Cyber Security Secretary

1. *Luka Corliss*

Keep a lot of the things that worked such as weekly sessions, QA

Help members stage talks

Provide resources to increase their knowledge in cybersec

2. *Ryan Hardwick*

Feels thereâ€™s a high barrier to entry on the CyberSec

Help attendees learn skills via TryHackMe

Workshops to secure websites

3. *Zac Garby*

Give a better understanding of Cybersec to members

Stop using HackTheBox

Could try JuiceShop

Organise local CTF challenges

4. Questions

None recorded

*Speaker Acquisition Secretary*1. *Jacob Garby*

Past talks have been great, not changing too much.

Add a method for people to vote for their favourite topic/speaker

2. *Natasha Bayliss*

Have a lot of experience communicating with groups from previous jobs

Is going on an internship with industry experts, would like to use those connections.

Use the suggestions box, push for member choice.

*Questions —*1. *SK*: How would you balance your time as Speaker Sec?

JG:

Try his best to keep the speakers frequent.

Put off speakers if time management gets tough

NB:

Has experience balancing time.

Make sure neither is affected by the other.

Plan ahead.

2. *DC*: What areas would you look at to find speakers?

JG:

Hackspace in Nottingham and TechNottingham

NB:

No recorded response

*Welfare and Inclusivity Secretary**Industrial Partners Secretary**Marketing Secretary**Social Media Secretary**Graphics Officer***Election Results**

1. President

Round 1: Aaron Osher won with 27 of 27 votes

Winner: Aaron Osher

2. Vice President

Round 1: Alexander Dewfall won with 26 of 27 votes

Winner: Alexander Dewfall

3. Treasurer

Round 1: Neve Marpole won with 17 of 26 votes

Winner: Neve Marpole

4. General Secretary

Round 1: Reece Roberts won with 25 of 27 votes

Winner: Reece Roberts

5. Development Secretary

Round 1: Peter Taylor won with 17 of 26 votes

Winner: Peter Taylor

6. Cyber-Security Secretary

Round 1: Luka Corliss was eliminated with 4 of 26 votes

Round 2: Ryan Hardwick won with 15 of 26 votes

Winner: Ryan Hardwick

7. Speaker Acquisition Secretary

Round 1: Natasha Bayliss won with 21 of 27 votes

Winner: Natasha Bayliss

8. Welfare and Inclusivity Secretary

Round 1: Molly Shalliker won with 27 of 27 votes

Winner: Molly Shalliker

9. Industrial Partners Secretary

Round 1: Samuel King won with 25 of 27 votes

Winner: Samuel King

10. Marketing Secretary

Round 1: Reece Roberts won with 23 of 27 votes

Winner: Reece Roberts

11. Social Media Secretary

Round 1: James Frost was eliminated with 4 of 17 votes

Round 2: Ashleigh Haxie won with 11 of 17 votes

Winner: Ashleigh Haxie¹

12. Graphics Officer

Round 1: Reece Harvey won with 27 of 27 votes

Winner: Reece Harvey

Next Meeting: EGM to be held after Exams - Date TBA

¹Result does not stand due to membership status and post will be filled by byelection at pending EGM